his side. The Maharaja needed to free himself from the slow strangulation that was on offer as Kashmir was forcibly propelled towards political reform. Kak had his eyes set on striking a deal with the emerging state of Pakistan. In his dispatch from Srinagar on 14 November 1946, the British Resident in Jammu and Kashmir reported as much.

It had been a major objective of the British policy, from the 19th century, to insulate the state of Jammu and Kashmir from Russian influence. After the start of the Cold War, the possibility of Subhash Chandra Bose's refuge in the Soviet Union and the Soviet presence in Sinkiang posed to be potential threats to the Gilgit lease and the security of Jammu and Kashmir, thereby threatening the stability of the post-independence government in the rest of the subcontinent. All these interests would be best served if Jammu and Kashmir was prevented from being the site of further foreign policy experiments. Resolute control over the state was clearly called for and many in the British administration believed that India was better equipped to exercise this control, than Pakistan.

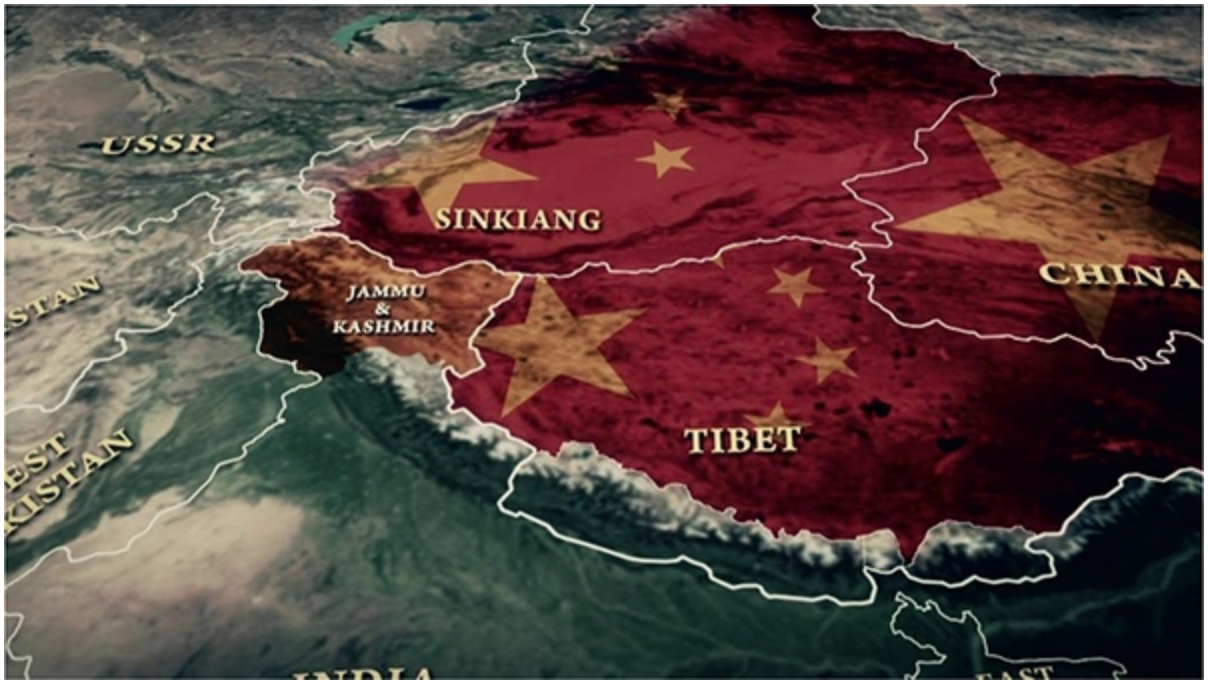


Image 4.2: Map of Chinese presence in Sinkiang and Tibet
Source: Archives of AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.